

Case Study 3

Agile Co-Dev

User Research

Heuristics Analysis

Data Analysis



The image is a collage of various software interface elements, likely from a project management or HR system. It includes several overlapping windows and panels. At the top left, there's a 'New Request' form with fields for 'Start Date', 'End Date', and 'Usage', and buttons for 'Submit' and 'Submit All'. Below this is a 'Project' window with a 'Teams & Cells' section and a 'Confirmation' section. The 'Confirmation' section contains a warning about end dates and a 'Requests to approve' section with a list of request IDs. To the right, there's a 'Split Request' window showing details for 'Request #169323' and options for 'New End Date' and 'Start Date for New Request'. Below that is a 'Split Position' window showing details for 'Position #169323'. At the bottom left, there's an 'Edit Project' window with fields for 'Name', 'Start Date', 'End Date', 'Project Group', 'Brand', 'Installment', 'Lead Studio', and 'Project Type'. To the right of that is a 'Force Vote' window showing a list of requests and their current start and end dates. At the bottom right, there's a table titled 'Expected Result on Requests' with columns for 'Request #', 'Start Date', 'End Date', 'Assigned', 'Update', and 'Status'. The table lists several requests with their respective dates and status updates. The overall design is clean and modern, with a focus on data entry and workflow management.

Executive Summary

The Problem

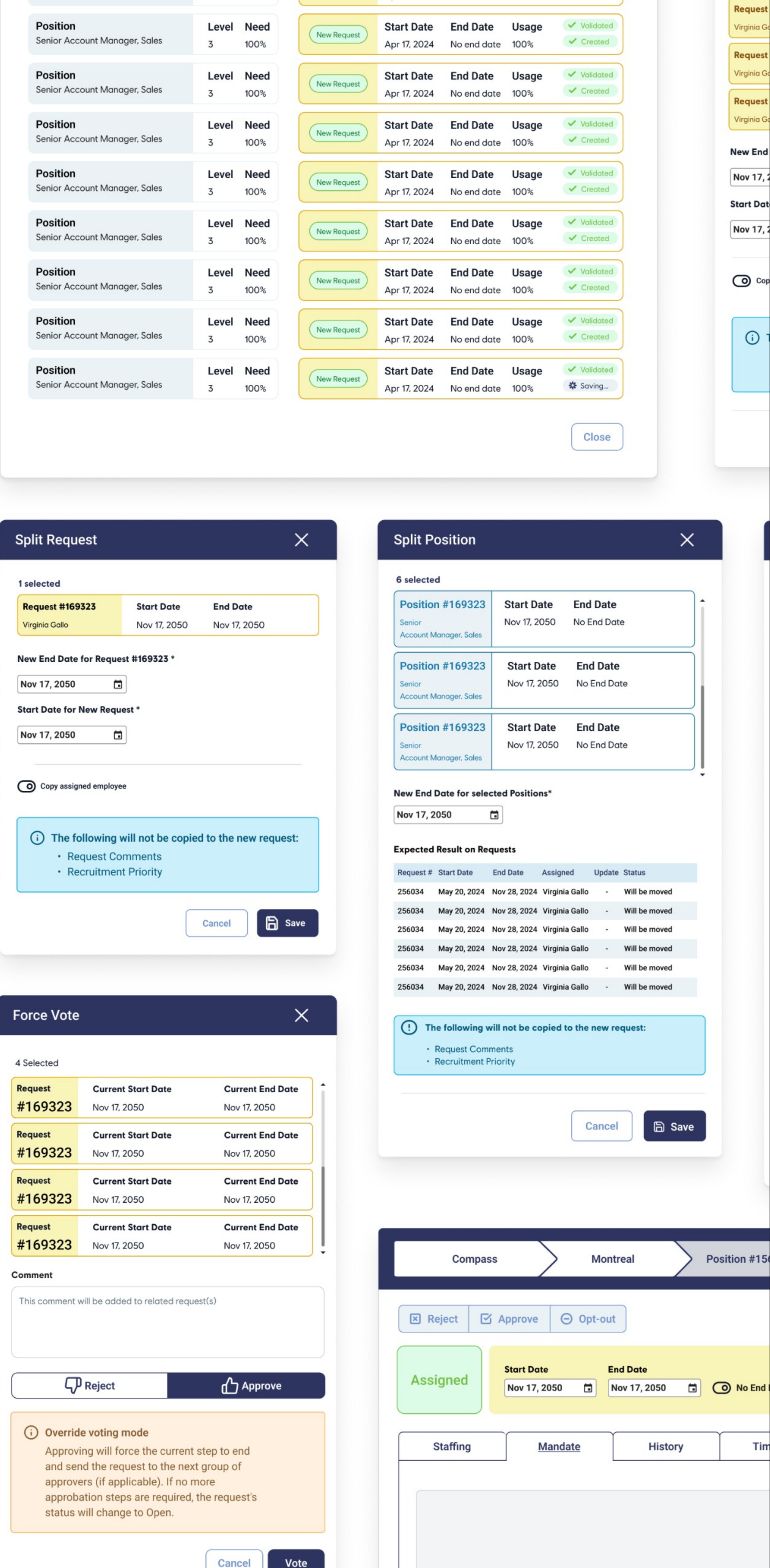
RPM is Ubisoft's primary resource planning tool, but a previous redesign left the platform with scattered workflows, confusing terminology, and a massive lack of user trust. Project Managers were overwhelmed and adoption stalled globally.

My Role & Action

As the lead UX Specialist, I initiated foundational user research to map pain points. Over 4 months, I led the strategy to consolidate 40+ modals, redesign the primary navigation ribbon, and split complex date-editing logic into digestible steps.

The Impact

By transforming the tool from an obstacle into a reliable utility, we drastically reduced user errors related to staffing timelines. The redesigned workflows established the scalable foundation required to confidently roll out RPM to global studios.





RPM

2019

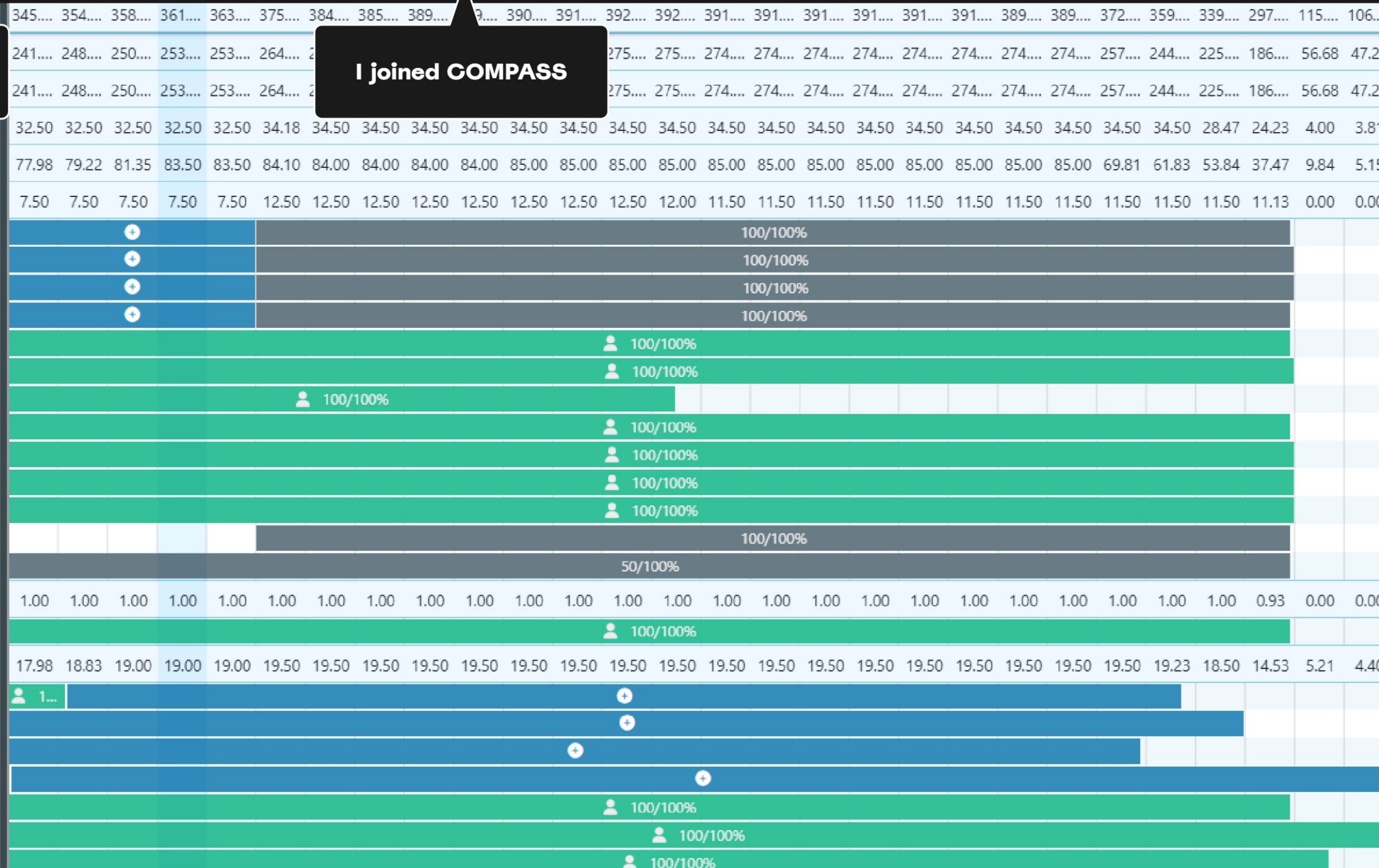
2021

2023

Projects' Request Usage					
Project: FAR CRY BLACKBIRD					
Studio: Montreal					
Job Function: Animation					
Job Function: Art					
Job Function: Audio					
	Unassigned	Associate A...	4	100	
	Unassigned	Audio Desig...	3	100	
	Unassigned	Voice Desig...	3	100	
	Unassigned	Voice Desig...	2	100	
9457	Assigned	Tchae Mea...	Audio Artist	4	100
56096	Assigned	Unai Gomez	Voice Desig...	4	100
56110	Assigned	Martin Lap...	Audio Desig...	3	100
56660	Assigned	Christoph...	Audio Direc...	4	100
66866	Assigned	Xavier Gau...	Audio Desig...	3	100
67397	Assigned	John Alexi...	Lead Audio ...	3	100
98419	Assigned	Michel Ma...	Audio Desig...	4	100
115551	Open	Unassigned	Audio Desig...	2	100
137833	Open	Unassigned	Voice Desig...	2	100
Job Function: Creative Direction					
9605	Assigned	Fabien Go...	Creative Dir...	5	100
Job Function: Game Design					
	Unassigned	Game Desig...	2	100	
	Unassigned	UX Designer	3	100	
	Unassigned	UX Designer	2	100	
	Unassigned	Associate C...	4	100	
	Unassigned	Game Direc...	5	100	
9323	Assigned	John Eric B...	Lead Syste...	4	100
9351	Assigned	Alexis Ane...	Lead Syste...	3	100

RPM redesign

I joined COMPASS



RPM Planning 2023

The problem

Lack of clarity and a fundamental misunderstanding of users and their painpoints.

I proposed a formal research process to uncover the real user landscape and create clarity around what to fix, for whom, and why.

What was broken

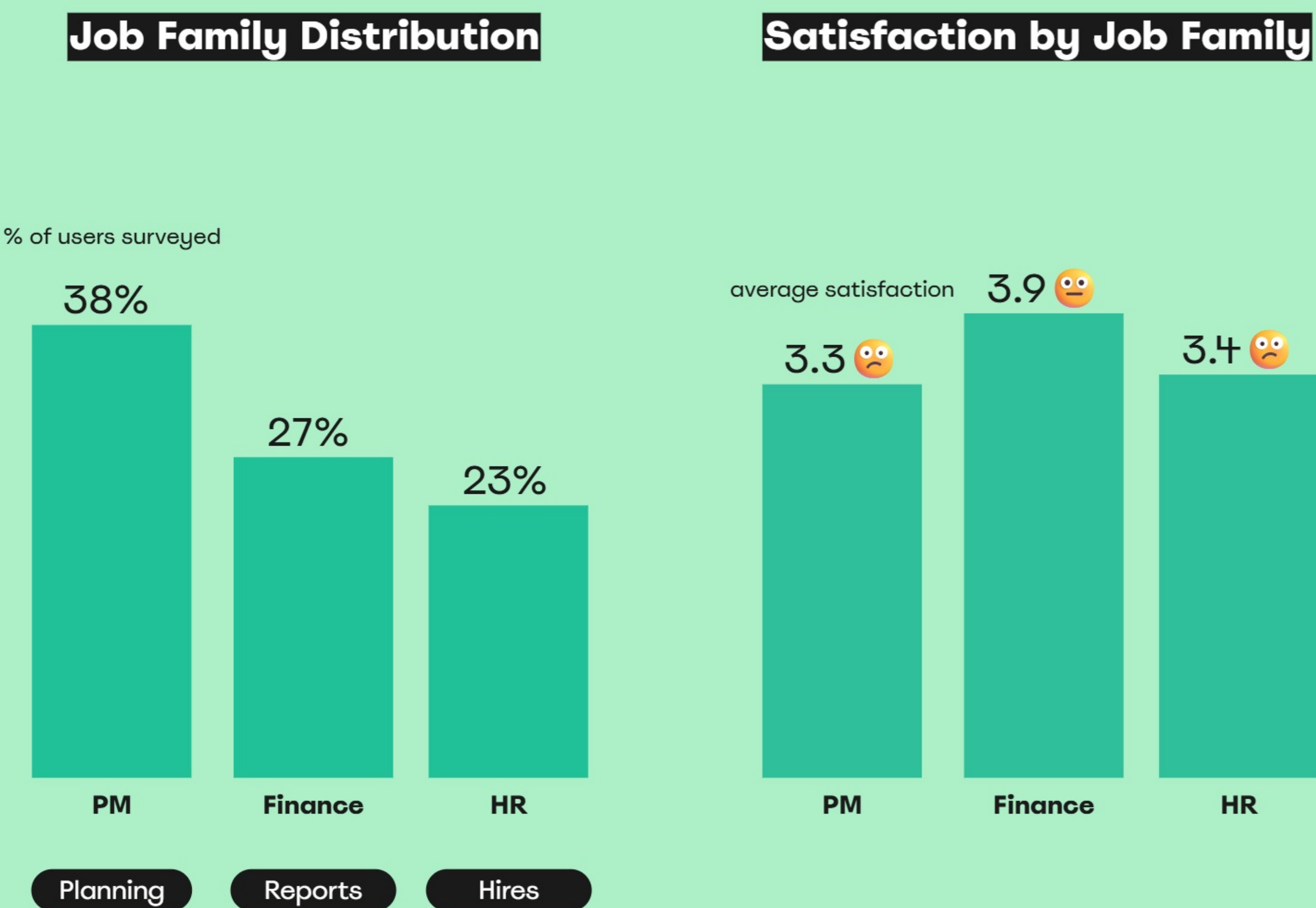
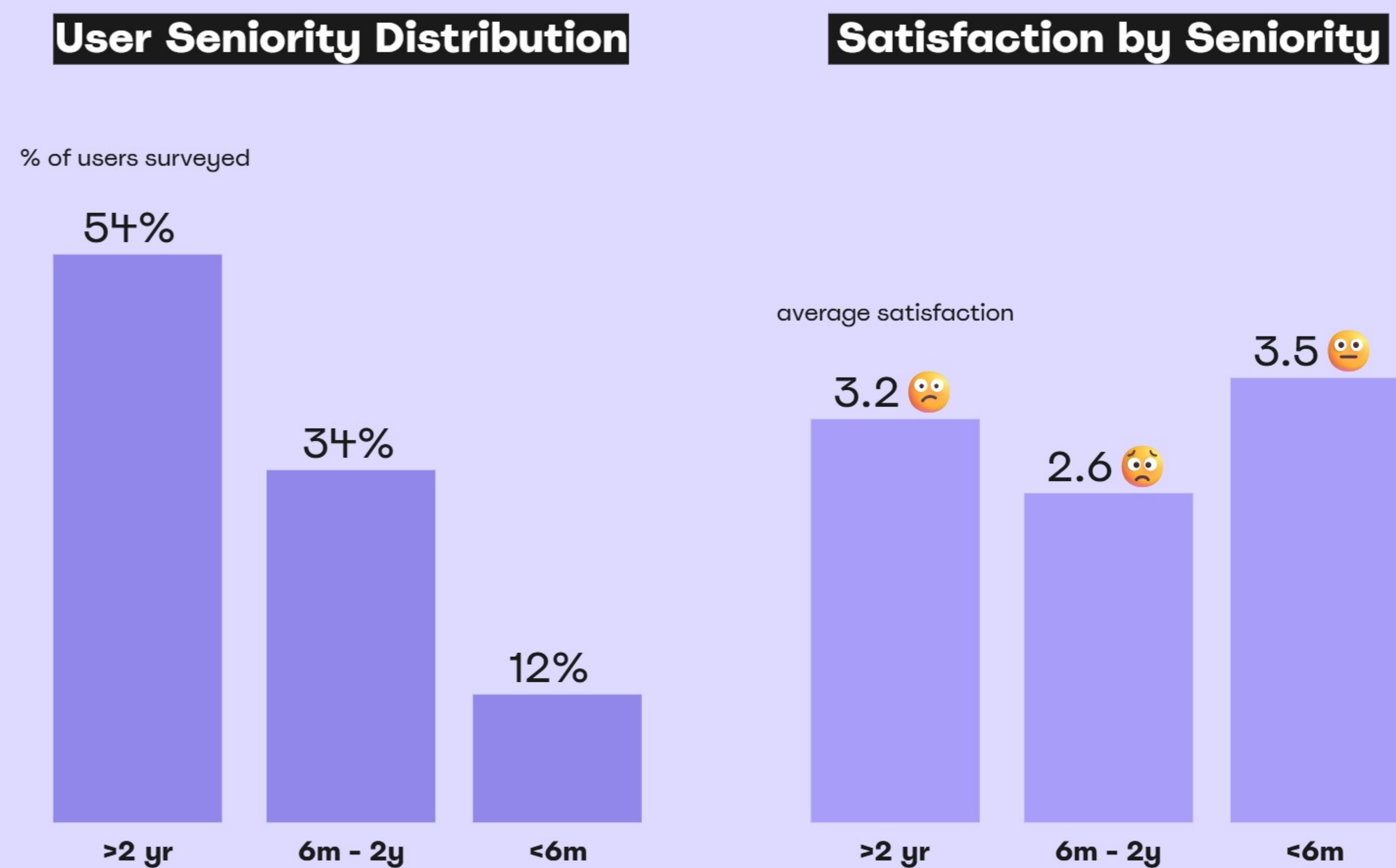
- When I joined the RPM team, the tool was flooded with complaints, but no one had identified the root causes. A recent redesign had changed both the interface and the workflows, but it was done without UX input or a clear understanding of the people using it. The result? A fresh coat of paint over foundational problems.
- There was no structured research. No user segmentation. The product owner was doing reactive one-on-ones, but couldn't see the bigger picture. (who used RPM, how they used it, or what pain points mattered most.)

The Goal

Rebuild trust through insight, not guesswork.

Research Insights

To anchor our roadmap, we launched a global **Satisfaction Survey** and received 101 responses from users across Ubisoft. The results surfaced core disconnects between usage frequency, satisfaction, and role.



Who Was Struggling

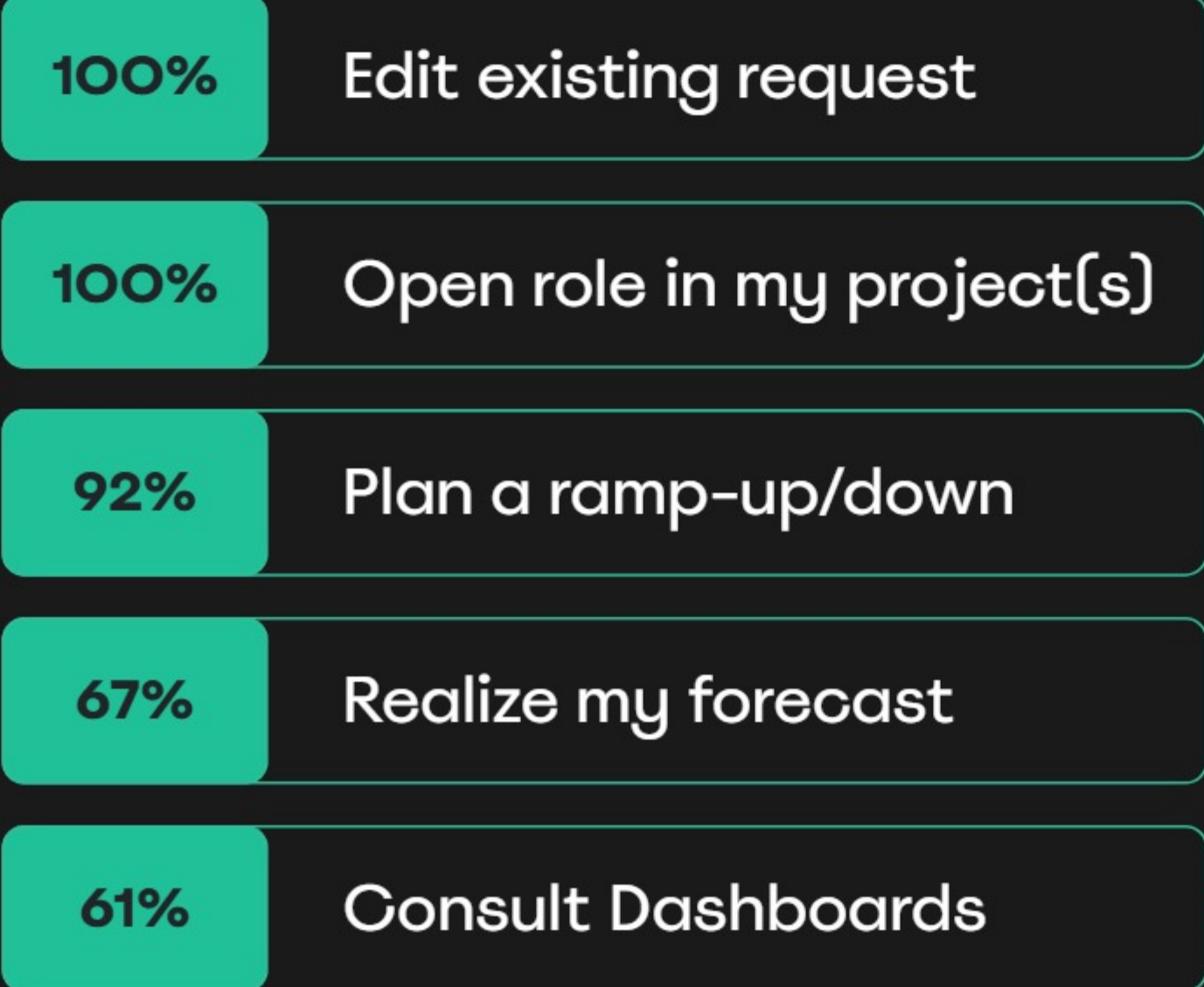
Seniority didn't help: Long-time users were the most frustrated, showing that time spent with the tool didn't ease confusion.

Frequent users rated RPM lowest for saving time. Both new and experienced users reported friction, with an average score of 2.16/5.

Project Managers were the largest group and the least satisfied 3.3/5, prompting us to run usability research and dig deeper.

Project Managers

Main Use Cases



Restricted to Executives

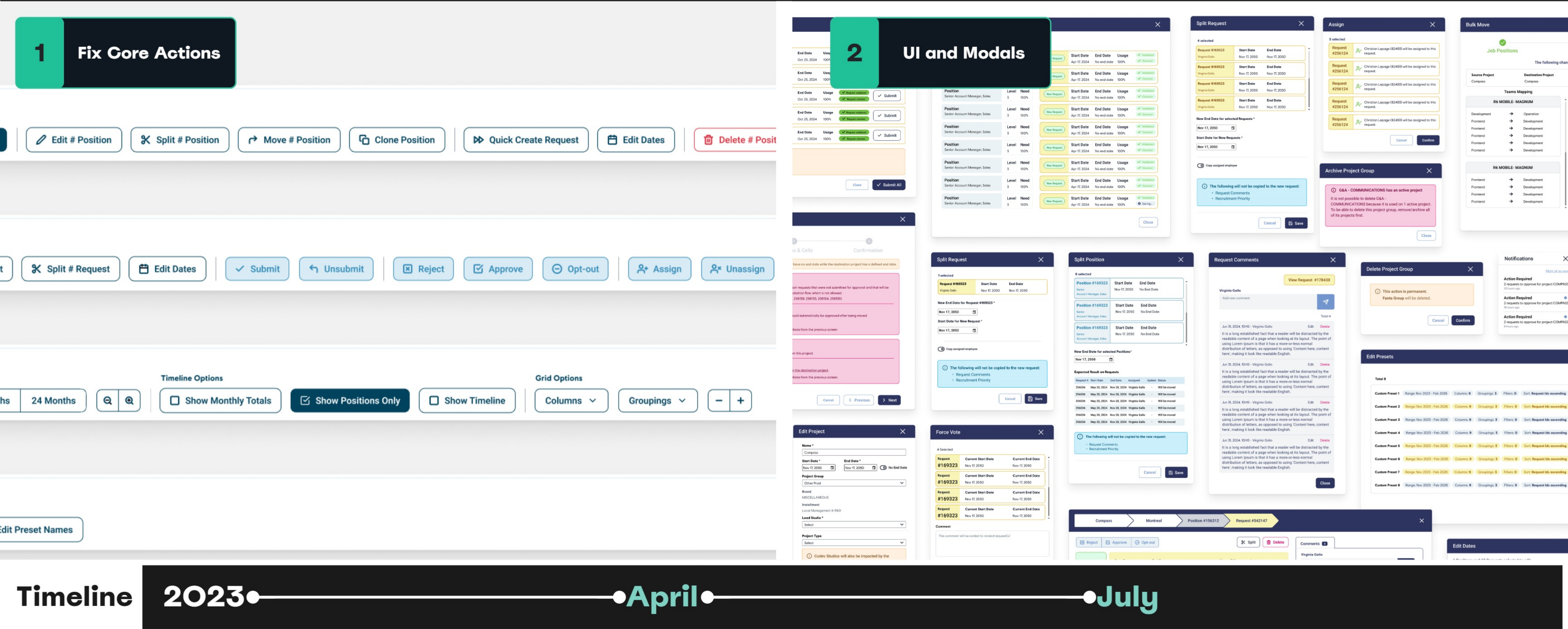
User Sentiments

FRUSTRATED
Too many clicks for simple tasks and difficulty finding key features

OLD
The tool felt outdated and visually cluttered

OVERWHELMED
Users didn't know where to look or what to do next

A full rebuild wasn't realistic. Instead, I proposed a **phased UX strategy**



Our Vision

Research revealed a deeper issue than missing features or poor UI. Users didn't trust RPM.

As a result, adoption remained limited to roughly a quarter of Ubisoft studios, with usage concentrated mainly in Canada and France.

Phase 1: The Ribbon

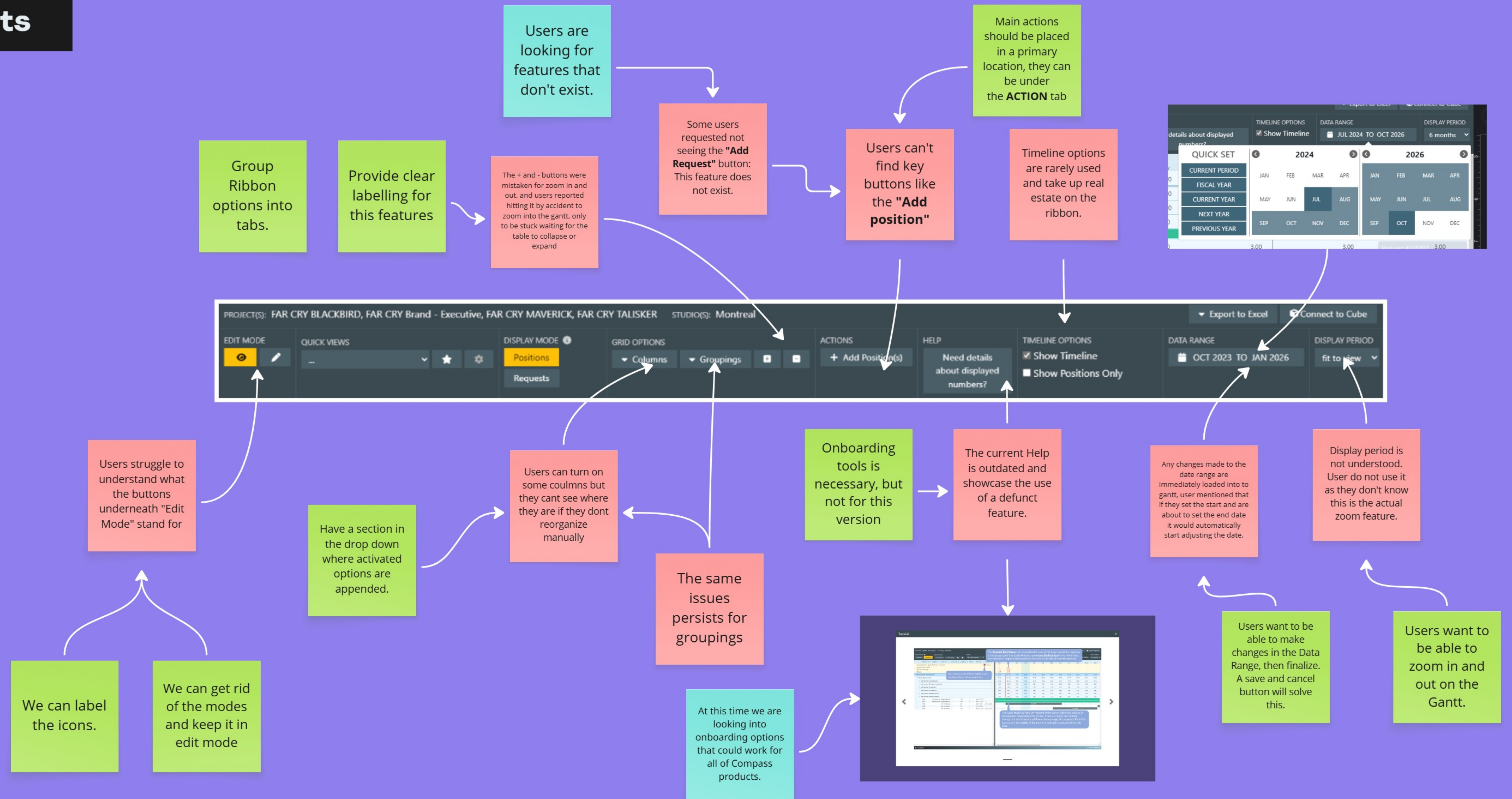
- We started where the pain was most visible, the **Ribbon**. This was RPM's primary navigation surface and one of the most cited friction points in both surveys and interviews. Users didn't understand the structure, misread icons, and assumed entire features were missing.

Phase 2: The Modals

- After fixing navigation and visibility, we tackled RPM's highest-risk modals—key to staffing, requests, and planning—that caused errors, rework, and support tickets.
- We audited 40+ modals, prioritized Position, Request, and Advanced Date Editor, and rebuilt them with the product team.

Ribbon Pain Points

- UX problems
- Early solution ideas
- Team notes



Dev PO UX BA

UX Alignment Kickoff

Before jumping into design work, I ran a cross-functional brainstorm session with the team to map the biggest UX breakdowns in RPM.

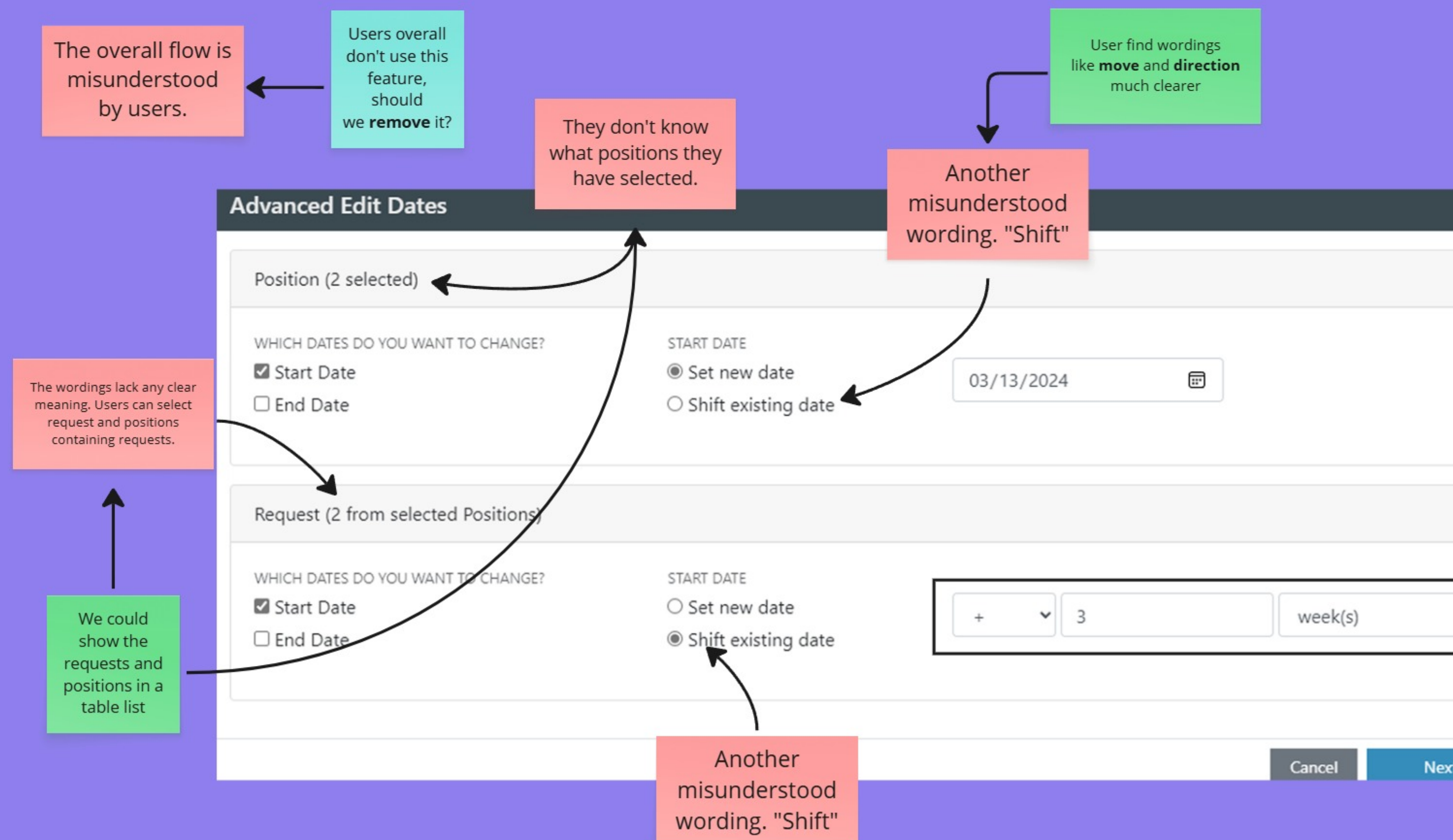
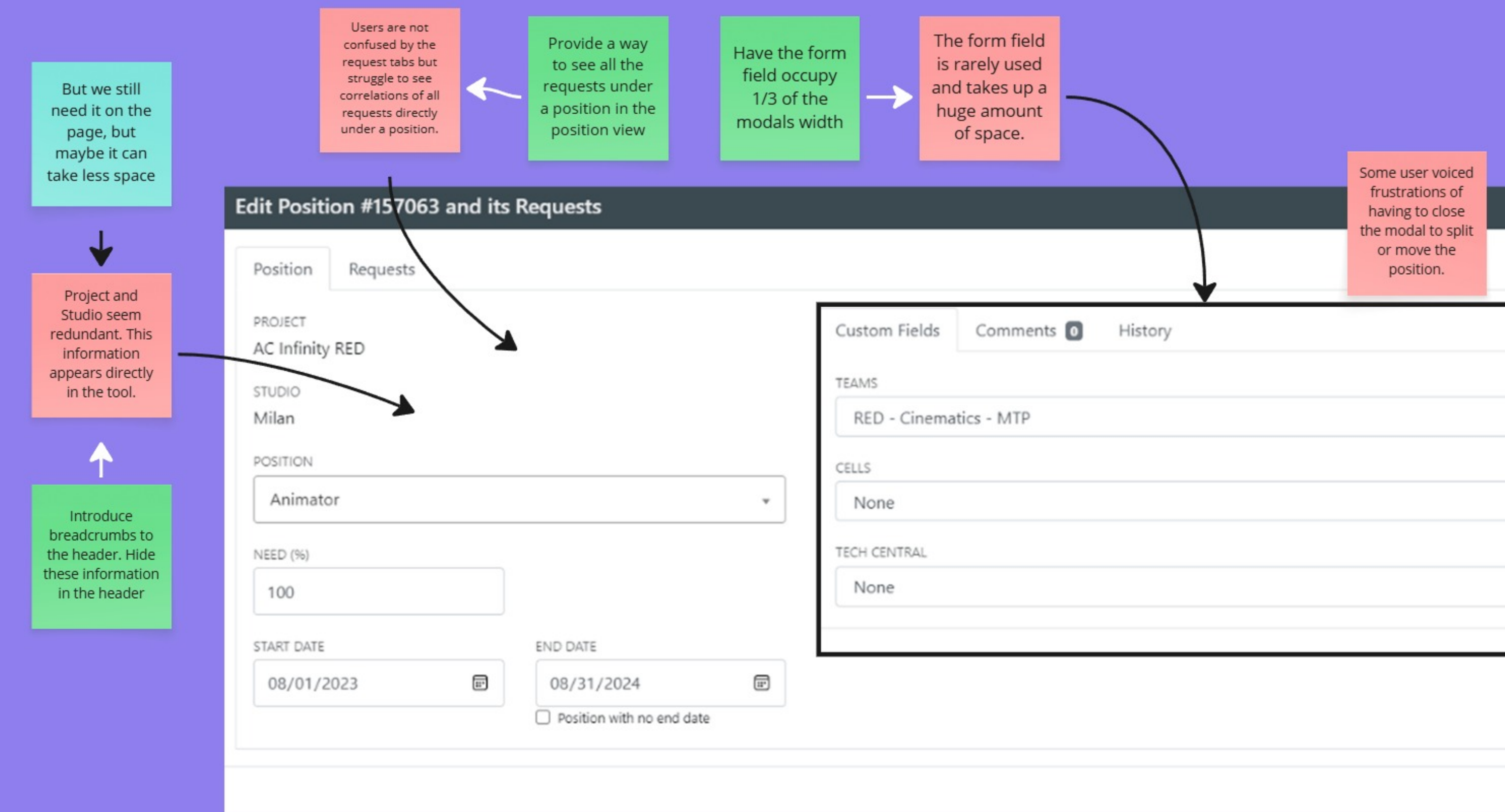
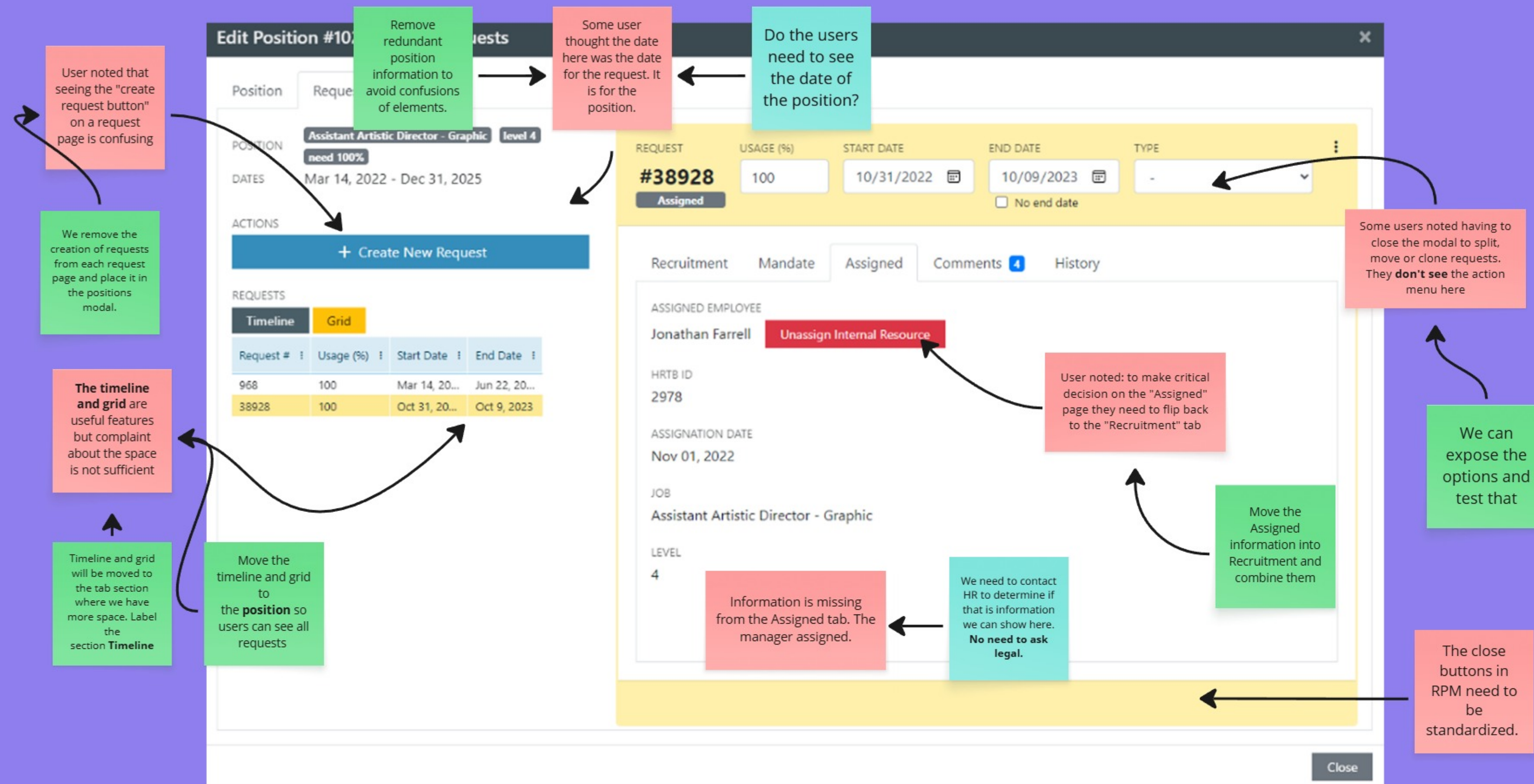
Objective 1
Identify key usability issues in the Ribbon and Modal UI using user feedback

Objective 2
Explore multiple design solutions for each pain point

Objective 3
Prioritize based on impact vs effort for handoff to the BA and roadmap planning

3 Major Modals

- UX problems
- Early solution ideas
- Team notes

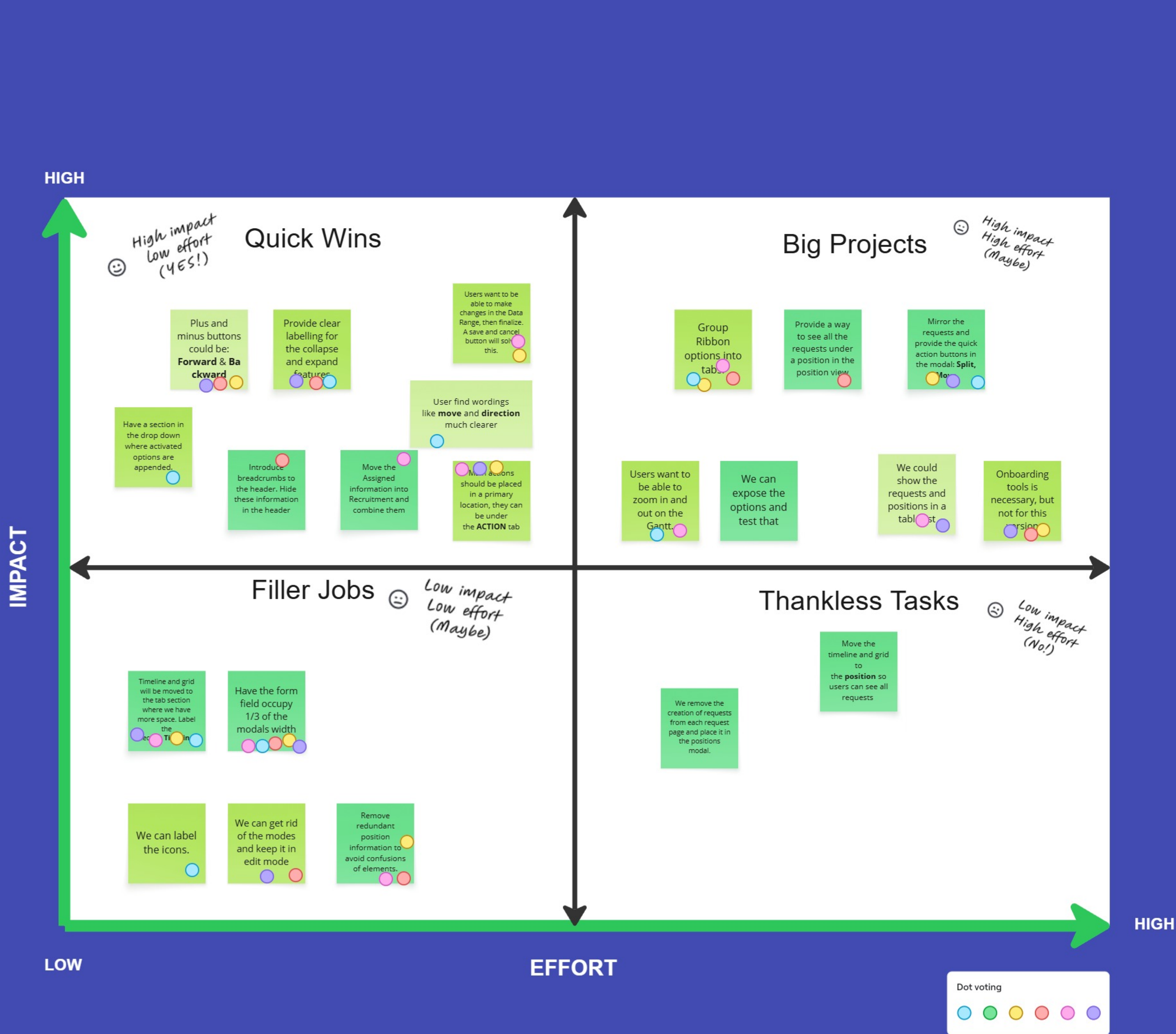


Dev PO UX BA

UX Alignment Kickoff part 2

Prioritizing

After brainstorming over 20 solutions, we used dot-voting and an Impact vs Effort matrix to prioritize actions. The top items became our “quick wins” for early delivery, while more complex flows were phased into future sprints.



Quick Wins

- Plus and minus buttons could be: **Forward & Backward**
- Provide clear labelling for the collapse and expand features
- Users want to be able to make changes in the Data Range, then finalize. A save and cancel button will sort this.
- Have a section in the drop down where activated options are appended.
- Introduce breadcrumbs to the header. Hide these information in the header
- Move the Assigned information into Recruitment and combine them
- User find wordings like **move** and **direction** much clearer

Filler Jobs

- Timeline and grid will be moved to the tab section where we have more space. Label the icons: **Timeline**
- Have the form field occupy 1/3 of the modals width
- Remove redundant position information to avoid confusions of elements.
- We can get rid of the modes and keep it in edit mode
- We can label the icons.

Big Projects

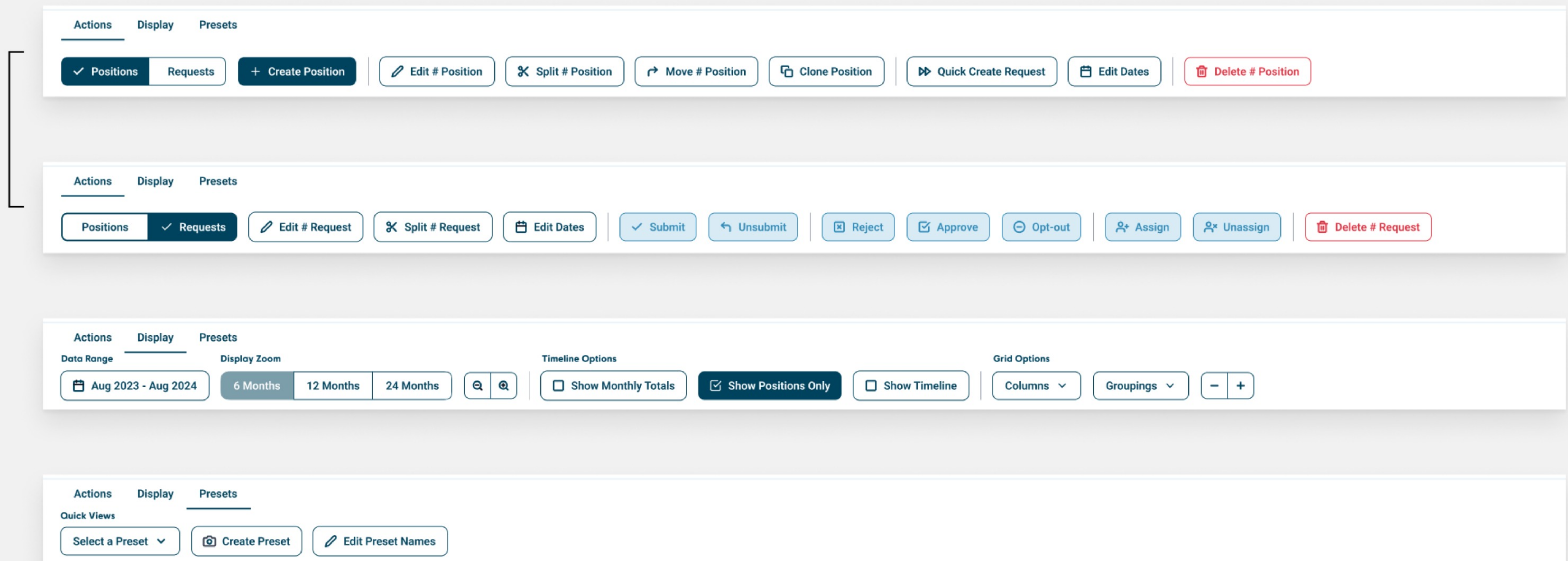
- Group Ribbon options into tab
- Mirror the requests and provide the quick action buttons in the modal: **Split**
- Onboarding tools is necessary, but not for this version
- We could show the requests and positions in a table
- Users want to be able to zoom in and out on the Gantt.
- Provide a way to see all the requests under a position in the position view
- We can expose the options and test that

Thankless Tasks

- We can remove the creation of requests from each request page and place it in the positions model.
- Move the timeline and grid to the **position** so users can see all requests

Ribbon Redesign

The Ribbon was RPM's primary navigation surface, so tackling it was our first step to victory. We focused on two things: clarity and scalability.



Strategy

We grouped related actions, exposed frequent tools, and restructured the layout around how teams actually worked; while leaving enough space for new features and system growth.

3 New Tabs

Actions Tab

High-frequency actions now left-aligned and clearly labeled

Display Tab

Gantt and Table tools relabeled and visually grouped

Presets Tab

Quick views separated for clarity and future scalability

Position Modal

Confusion here delayed staffing decisions, triggered duplicate entries, and led to frequent support requests, often for simple tasks.

The screenshot shows the 'Position Modal' interface. On the left, four callouts point to specific features: 1. Breadcrumbs (COMPASS > Montreal > Position #300946), 2. Inline Actions (Split, Duplicate, Move, Delete), 3. Clear CTA (+ Create Request), and 4. Integrated Request Area (a table of requests). A yellow box at the bottom left labeled 'Other Improvements' points to the right side of the modal, which contains dropdown menus for Teams, Cells, Codev, Product Line, Stagiaire, CDD, and New Custom Field.

Breadcrumbs 1

Inline Actions 2

Clear CTA 3

Integrated Request Area 4

Other Improvements

COMPASS > Montreal > Position #300946

Position

Job Position * Accountant Level * 1

Need * 100 Start Date * 01/13/2025 End Date mm/dd/yyyy No End Date

Requests + Create Request

#256714	Start Date: Jan 13, 2025	End Date: Feb 13, 2030
Open	Assignee: -	Usage: 100%
#256742	Start Date: Feb 14, 2030	End Date: No End Date
Created	Assignee: -	Usage: 100%

Teams None

Cells None

Codev None

Product Line None

Stagiaire None

CDD None

New Custom Field None

What it's used for

The Position Modal is where project managers define roles, assign dates, and initiate staffing. It's one of the most-used screens in RPM and a core point of failure in the tool.

Solutions

1 - Breadcrumbs

Replaced static labels with breadcrumbs to show hierarchy and context.

2 - Inline Actions

Added the most-used actions: Split, Clone and Move, directly inside the modal.

3 - Clear CTA

Introduced "+ Create Request" as a clear step forward for Production Managers.

4 - Integrated Request Area

Moved request entry directly into the modal, eliminating tab-switching.

Request Modal

The previous design caused confusion, decision delays, and downstream errors. It lacked visual hierarchy, scattered critical inputs, and forced users to dig for approval actions.

The image shows a 'Request Modal' interface with several key features highlighted by numbered callouts:

- 1 - Approval actions:** A row of buttons at the top right: 'Reject', 'Approve', 'Opt-out', and 'Submit'.
- 2 - Clear Request Status:** A yellow box labeled 'Submitted' on the left side of the modal.
- 3 - New Staffing Tab:** A tab labeled 'Staffing' (highlighted with a yellow dot) among other tabs like 'Mandate', 'History', and 'Timeline'.
- 4 - Comments Section:** A section on the right side titled 'Comments' with a 'Favour Diokpo' button and a list of comments.

Other improvements include a 'Start Date' field (10/23/2024), an 'End Date' field (03/12/2025), a 'Usage' field (100), and a 'Recruitment Studio(s)' dropdown menu (Montreal, Quebec).

What it's used for

The Request Modal is where staffing gets finalized. It connects the defined role (Position) with an actual resource, making it essential to both project planning and HR operations.

Solutions

1 - Approval Actions

Moved approval actions into the request modal, where the action mattered most.

2 - Clear Request Status

Reused Gantt status colors in the modal so users instantly recognize request states.

3 - New Staffing Tab

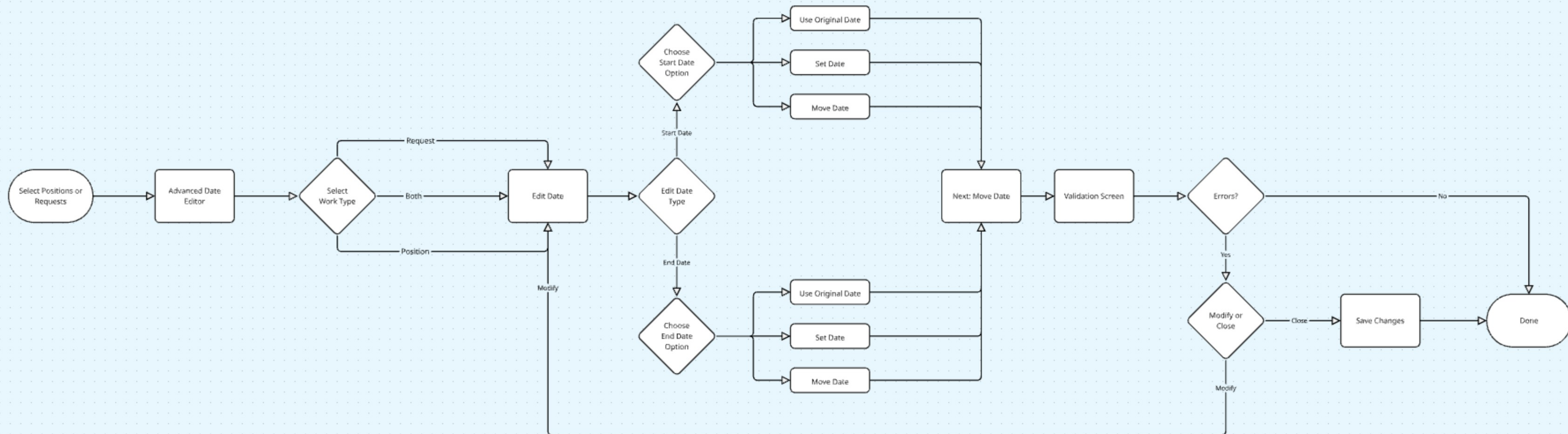
Merged Recruitment and Assigned tabs, to reduced cognitive overload.

4 - Comments Section

Created a dedicated space for real-time collaboration and history

Advanced Date Editor

One of the most error-prone modals in the system due to the confusing user flow.



Sketching & Flows

I mapped the original flow users followed when editing dates. The sequence was rigid, ambiguous, and offered no clear separation between Start and End Date interactions. With the old flow mapped I proposed splitting the logic for Start and End Date editing. This allowed users to make precise, independent adjustments, reducing accidental changes and supporting clearer validation.

Updated Flow

1 User selects whether to edit
Start Date or End Date

2 User chooses from three options:

- Set Date
- Move Date
- Use Original Dates

4 System runs validation and
displays contextual feedback

3 User inputs values

Advanced Date Editor

One of the most error-prone modals in the system due to the confusing user flow.

Visual on Selected Objects

1

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Dates' modal with the following elements:

- Header:** 'Edit Dates' with a close button.
- Left Panel:** A list of 6 positions and 12 requests. Each item has a checkbox and a dropdown menu. The first item is 'Pos. 123567 - Analyst Programmer' with a dropdown showing 'Req. 789234 - Michel Tanguay', 'Req. 789234 - Open', and 'Req. 789234 - Virginia Gallo'. The second item is 'Pos. 123567 - Team Lead' with a dropdown showing 'Req. 789234 - Open'. The third item is 'Pos. 123567 - Analyst Programmer' with a dropdown showing 'Req. 789234 - Michel Tanguay', 'Req. 789234 - Open', and 'Req. 789234 - Virginia Gallo'. The fourth item is 'Pos. 123567 - Team Lead' with a dropdown showing 'Req. 789234 - Open'. The fifth item is 'Pos. 123567 - Analyst Programmer' with a dropdown showing 'Req. 789234 - Michel Tanguay', 'Req. 789234 - Open', and 'Req. 789234 - Virginia Gallo'. The sixth item is 'Pos. 123567 - Team Lead' with a dropdown showing 'Req. 789234 - Open'.
- Right Panel:** 'Edit Date For:' with tabs 'Both', 'Request Only', and 'Position Only'. Below are two sections: 'Start Date' and 'End Date'.
 - Start Date:** Radio buttons for 'Use Original Dates', 'Set Date', and 'Move Date'. Under 'Move Date', there are radio buttons for 'Forward' and 'Backward'. Below that is a 'By:' section with a text input 'Enter a number' and a dropdown 'month(s)'.
 - End Date:** Radio buttons for 'Use Original Dates', 'Set Date', and 'Move Date'. Under 'Set Date', there is a date input 'Nov 17, 2050' and a 'No End Date' button. Under 'Move Date', there is a 'No End Date' button.
- Bottom:** 'Cancel' and 'Next' buttons.

Clear Impact

Natural wording

Error Validation Checks

Improvements

1 - Visual on Selected Objects

A section for chosen objects reduced selection and date-change errors

2 - Clear Impact

Users can easily identify which entities they want to adjust the dates for

3 - Natural wording

Users said "move forward" and "move backwards" in interviews, so we adapted.

4 - Error Validation Checks

Fixed previous issues where date changes failed and progress was lost.

Design System Alignment

Throughout the project, we worked closely with Ubisoft's shared design team **EGG** to adapt and expand their system to fit RPM's needs

UX - EGG b/w components

Position #300946

Split Clone Move Delete

Position: Accountant Level: 2 Need (%): 100

Start date: 01/13/2025 End date: mm/dd/yyyy No End Date

All Requests + Create Request

ID	Start date	End date	Assignee	Usage
#169323	Nov 17, 2050	Nov 17, 2050	Janet Doe	50%
#169323	Nov 17, 2050	Nov 17, 2050	John Doe	50%

Custom Fields History Comments 0

TEAMS: None

CELLS: None

PRODUCT LINE: None

STAGIAIRE: None

CDD: None

NEW CUSTOM FIELD: None

LEAD POSITION: ADSASAD

UI - EGG components

Compass Montreal Position #300946

Split Clone Move Delete

Position: Game Designer Level: 2

Need (%): 100 Start Date: Nov 17, 2050 End Date: Nov 17, 2050 No End Date

Requests + Create Request

ID	Start Date	End Date	Assigned Employee	Usage
#169323	Nov 17, 2050	Nov 17, 2050	Janet Doe	50%
#169323	Nov 17, 2050	Nov 17, 2050	John Doe	50%

Custom Fields History Comments 0

Teams: Select an option

Cells: Select an option

Product line: Select an option

Stagiaire: Select an option

CDD: Select an option

Code - EGG components

COMPASS Montreal Position #300946

Split Duplicate Move Delete

Position: Accountant Level: 1

Need: 100 Start Date: 01/13/2025 End Date: mm/dd/yyyy No End Date

Requests + Create Request

ID	Start Date	End Date	Assignee	Usage
#256714	Jan 13, 2025	Feb 13, 2030	-	100%
#256742	Feb 14, 2030	No End Date	-	100%

Custom Fields History Comments 0

Teams: None

Cells: None

Codex: None

Product Line: None

Stagiaire: None

CDD: None

New Custom Field: None

Lead position: ADSASAD

This collaboration helped us define consistent component behaviors, simplify handoff, and keep both UX, UI and dev teams aligned. Because of that shared foundation, developers were able to use the exact same components from our designs in production.

The Result

Faster implementation, fewer inconsistencies, and a tighter feedback loop between teams. This was about building a product that could scale with confidence, using internal resources in smarter, more integrated ways.

Outcomes & Projected Impact

40%

Estimated reduction in time-on-task for core workflows by consolidating the navigation ribbon and standardizing modal layouts.

~60%

Drop in date-syncing errors achieved by splitting start/end date logic in the Advanced Date Editor.

35%

Projected increase in global adoption as usability improvements restored trust among previously skeptical studio leads.

4/5

Montreal Studio GSAT (up from 3.5). Additionally, overall negative feedback dropped dramatically from **30%** in 2024 to just **10%** in 2025.

User Sentiment Shift

2024 Pre-Revamp Friction

"There is no common way to use it. The complexity for new users is high, and figuring out how to reallocate people is difficult."

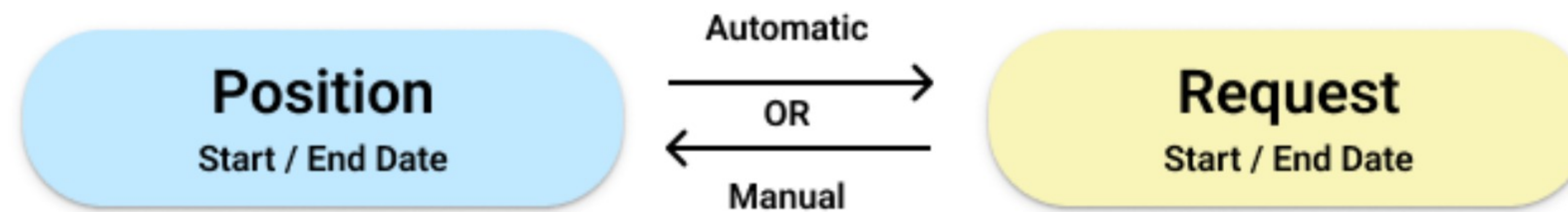
2025 Post-Revamp Adoption

"An essential tool for coordinating and monitoring staffing plans. We finally have consistency in data and a clean, logical visual UI/UX."

2025 Post-Revamp Feature Praise

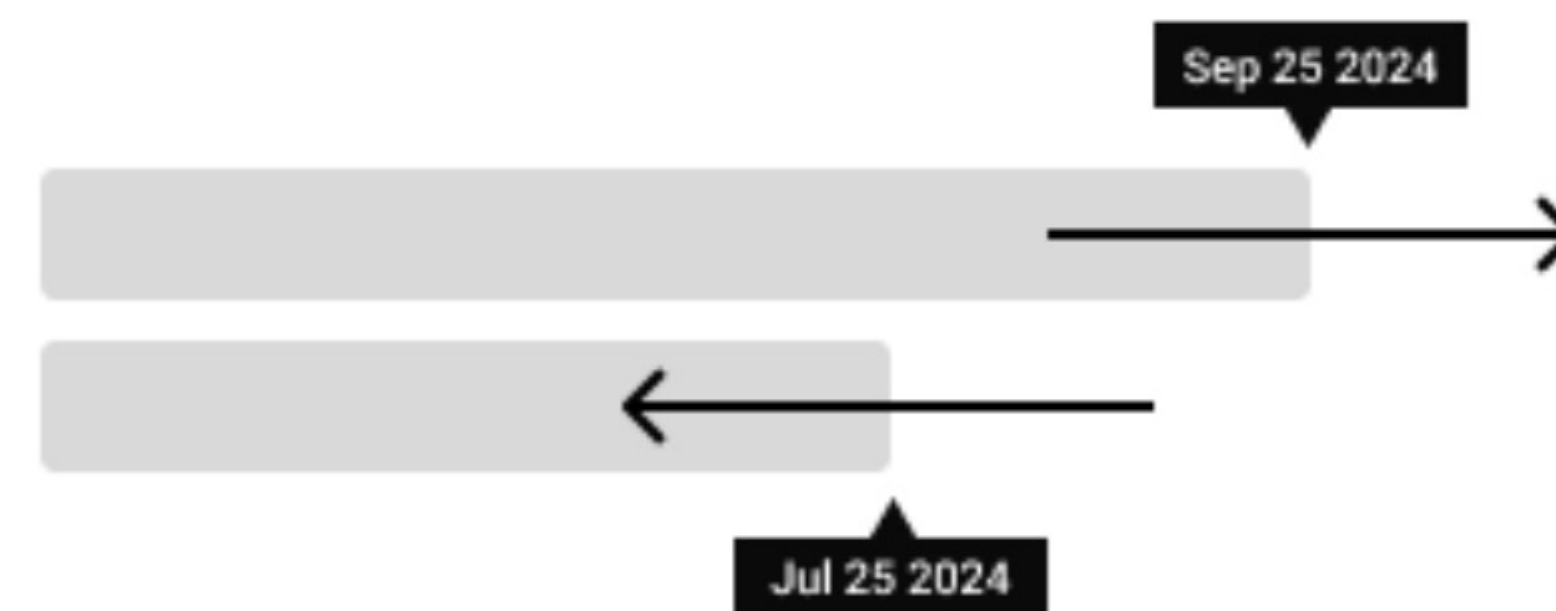
"Being able to slide positions and requests directly in the timeline makes planning quite easy."

1

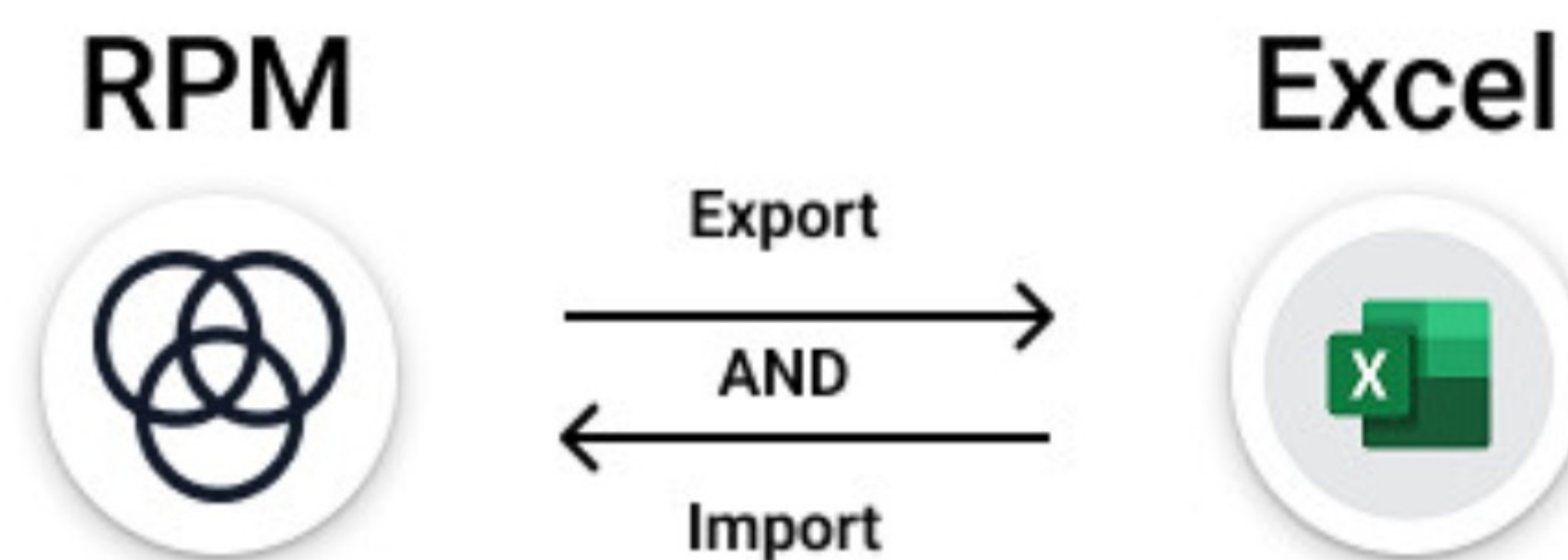


2

Expand and Contract



3



What Came Next

The end of this case study wasn't the end of RPM's evolution. Since completing the core redesigns, we've continued shipping high-impact updates that were made possible by the foundations we put in place.

1] Date Syncing Between Position and Request

Solved a long-standing pain point by aligning start and end date logic, reducing user error and eliminating sync-related confusion across modals.

2] Expand and Contract in the Gantt

Our most-requested feature—bringing speed and flexibility to setting start or end dates for positions and requests directly in the Gantt view.

3] Excel Import & Export

Designed for our Finance and Analysis users, this feature supports massive data changes with confidence.

Retrospective & Learnings



Validating through data

By securing buy-in to run ongoing Satisfaction Surveys, we moved away from reactive design. Tracking our progress allowed us to see mid-tenure user satisfaction (6m-3y) jump massively from a critical 2.6 up to 3.7, proving our foundational UX fixes actually solved the core frustration.

Understanding legacy systems

If I were to do this again, I would bring the back-end engineering team into the sketching phase much sooner. Understanding the deep database constraints around how "Requests" and "Positions" were inextricably linked would have accelerated my iteration process for the modal redesigns.

Growth as a systems thinker

This project required rigorous systems thinking. Rebuilding an enterprise tool used by 1000+ employees meant I had to understand the downstream impact of every single input. It taught me how to prioritize deep usability fixes that drive quantifiable business value, resulting in our flagship Montreal studio reaching a 4.0 satisfaction score.